

CORPORATE HUMAN RESOURCES POLICY

Standard Operating Procedures, Code of Conduct, and Employee Governance

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Applicability	All Full-Time, Part-Time, and Contract Employees

Table of Contents

Section	Topic Title	Page Reference
1.0	Document Overview & Governing Principles	Page 2
2.0	Code of Conduct & Ethical Workplace Standards	Page 3
3.0	Employment Classifications & Hours of Work	Page 4
4.0	Compensation, Payroll & Benefits Framework	Page 5
5.0	Time Off, Sick Leaves & Absence Governance	Page 6
6.0	Performance Management & Career Advancement	Page 7
7.0	Disciplinary Framework & Misconduct Governance	Page 8
8.0	Anti-Harassment, DEI & Workplace Safety	Page 9
9.0	Separation, Offboarding & Policy Acknowledgement	Page 10

1.0 Document Overview & Governing Principles

Apex Global Technologies Inc. ("Company") is committed to maintaining a high-performing, ethical, inclusive, and transparent workplace. This Human Resources Policy Manual establishes standard operating procedures for all employment actions across all enterprise locations.

Policy Mandate: Adherence to these policies is a condition of employment. Supervisors are required to enforce these standards consistently and equitably across all teams without exception.

1.1 Scope and Enforcement

This policy applies to all executive officers, managers, permanent full-time employees, part-time employees, temporary hires, and contingent workers across global operations. Where local labor legislation mandates higher standards, local statutory regulations shall supersede specific terms within this document.

Human Resources conducts annual audits of this document to ensure alignment with changing employment laws and enterprise business strategies.

2.0 Code of Conduct & Ethical Workplace Standards

Apex Global Technologies requires all personnel to act with absolute integrity, honesty, and professionalism in every professional interaction. Individual actions directly impact the firm's reputation, stakeholder trust, and operational integrity.

2.1 Professional Ethics & Conflicts of Interest

Employees must avoid any personal or financial interest that conflicts with the business interests of the Company. Potential conflicts of interest must be disclosed immediately to HR via the Compliance Portal.

- **External Employment:** Secondary employment or side consulting requires written approval from HR and Department Head.
- **Gifts & Hospitality:** Employees may not accept gifts, services, or entertainment exceeding \$100 in cumulative value annually from suppliers or clients.
- **Insider Information:** Misuse of non-public enterprise information for personal gain or sharing with third parties is illegal and grounds for termination.

2.2 Representation & Brand Integrity

Only designated enterprise spokespersons may communicate with media outlets, financial analysts, or regulatory bodies on behalf of Apex Global Technologies. Personal opinions expressed on social media must explicitly state that views do not represent the enterprise.

Whistleblower Protection: Employees reporting code violations in good faith are protected from retaliation, harassment, or adverse employment actions under our Corporate Whistleblower Charter.

3.0 Employment Classifications & Working Hours

Clear classification of employment status determines benefit eligibility, overtime pay calculation, and operational schedules across all enterprise business units.

Classification Category	Weekly Threshold	Benefits Eligibility	Overtime Eligibility
Regular Full-Time	35 - 40 Hours	Full Enterprise Package	Exempt / Non-Exempt (By Law)
Regular Part-Time	20 - 29 Hours	Pro-rated Medical/Leave	Non-Exempt
Temporary / Seasonal	Variable	Statutory Only	Non-Exempt
Contractor / Consultant	Project Based	None (Vendor Terms)	Ineligible

3.1 Core Working Hours & Scheduling

Standard enterprise operating hours are 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM local time, Monday through Friday. Core collaboration windows are maintained between 10:00 AM and 3:00 PM daily, during which all team members are expected to be available for meetings and synchronous tasks.

3.2 Hybrid & Remote Work Framework

Eligible personnel may participate in the Enterprise Hybrid Work Program, subject to manager approval and performance metrics. Hybrid employees are required to work from designated office hubs at least 2 days per calendar week.

Remote workers must maintain a secure, ergonomic workspace with reliable internet connectivity (minimum 50 Mbps down / 10 Mbps up) to ensure data confidentiality and productivity.

4.0 Compensation, Payroll & Benefits Framework

Apex Global Technologies maintains a competitive total rewards philosophy designed to attract, motivate, and retain top industry talent through equitable compensation structures.

4.1 Payroll Administration

Base compensation is disbursed semi-monthly on the 15th and last business day of each calendar month. Direct deposit to a nominated financial account is mandatory for all personnel.

4.2 Annual Performance Bonus

Eligible employees participate in the Annual Variable Incentive Plan. Bonuses are awarded based on a dual metric structure: 50% enterprise financial performance targets and 50% individual Key Performance Indicator (KPI) achievement.

4.3 Healthcare and Wellness Benefits

Comprehensive health benefits take effect on the 1st day of the calendar month following employment commencement. The core benefit plan includes:

- Comprehensive Medical, Dental, and Vision coverage (85% employer-subsidized for employee, 60% for dependents).
- Short-term and Long-term Disability Insurance (100% employer-funded).
- Group Life Insurance equal to 2x annual base salary.
- Wellness stipend up to \$500 annually for gym memberships or mental health apps.

5.0 Time Off, Sick Leaves & Absence Governance

The enterprise recognizes the importance of work-life balance and provides robust paid leave structures to support rest, recovery, and personal commitments.

Leave Type	Annual Allocation	Accrual Basis	Rollover Rules
Paid Time Off (PTO)	18 - 25 Days (By Tenure)	1.5 Days / Month	Max 5 Days to Next Year
Sick & Wellness Leave	10 Days	Frontloaded Jan 1	Use-it-or-lose-it
Parental Leave	16 Weeks Fully Paid	Upon Event	N/A
Bereavement Leave	3 - 5 Days	Per Instance	N/A

5.1 Paid Time Off (PTO) Booking Rules

PTO requests exceeding 3 consecutive days must be submitted through the HR Portal at least 14 days in advance. Managers must approve or deny requests within 3 business days, balancing coverage needs.

5.2 Sick Leave & Medical Verification

Employees unable to work due to illness must notify their direct manager before 8:30 AM on the day of absence. A licensed medical practitioner note is required for sick leave absences exceeding 3 consecutive business days.

6.0 Performance Management & Growth

Continuous feedback drives personal growth and enterprise success. Apex Global Technologies operates a continuous performance review cadence.

6.1 Review Cadence

- **Quarterly Goal Check-ins:** Alignment on OKRs (Objectives and Key Results).
- **Mid-Year Review:** Calibration on progress, competencies, and professional development needs.
- **Annual Performance Appraisal:** Formal evaluation determining merit increases and bonus distributions.

6.2 Performance Improvement Plans (PIP)

When employee performance falls consistently below job requirements, a formal 30, 60, or 90-day Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) may be initiated by the manager in consultation with HR.

PIP Requirements: A PIP defines clear, measurable targets, required support resources, and weekly milestone reviews. Failure to meet PIP targets leads to employment termination.

7.0 Disciplinary Framework & Misconduct Governance

To preserve enterprise standards, corrective disciplinary steps ensure fair treatment while addressing unsatisfactory conduct or rule violations.

7.1 Progressive Discipline Steps

1. **Verbal Warning:** Documented conversation addressing minor policy infractions.
2. **Written Warning:** Formal memo outlining corrective expectations placed in permanent HR file.
3. **Final Written Warning & Suspension:** Mandatory corrective action period; may include unpaid suspension.
4. **Termination of Employment:** Discharge from service following repeated or severe infractions.

7.2 Gross Misconduct

Gross misconduct leads to immediate summary dismissal without prior warnings or notice pay. Examples include theft, fraud, physical violence, gross insubordination, serious security breaches, or working under the influence of illegal substances.

8.0 Anti-Harassment, DEI & Workplace Safety

Apex Global Technologies enforces zero tolerance for discrimination, sexual harassment, bullying, or safety compromises.

8.1 Equal Opportunity & Non-Discrimination

All employment decisions are based on merit, skills, and business needs. Employment discrimination based on race, color, religion, gender, sexual orientation, age, disability, or veteran status is strictly illegal and prohibited.

8.2 Anti-Harassment Policy

Harassment consists of unwelcome verbal, visual, or physical conduct that creates an intimidating or hostile work environment. Any employee experiencing or witnessing harassment must report it to HR immediately.

Investigation Process: HR conducts confidential, impartial investigations within 5 business days of receiving a formal complaint. Substantiated claims result in swift disciplinary measures up to immediate termination.

9.0 Separation, Offboarding & Acknowledgement

Orderly offboarding protects corporate IP and ensures smooth operational transitions upon employment end.

9.1 Resignation Notice Requirements

Individual contributors must provide a minimum of 2 weeks written notice. Managers, Directors, and Executive Leadership must provide 4 weeks written notice.

9.2 Return of Company Property

On or before the final working day, employees must surrender all enterprise property including laptops, security badges, corporate cards, and proprietary documentation. Failure to return assets may result in legal recovery actions.

Policy Acknowledgement Form

By signing below, I acknowledge receiving, reading, and agreeing to comply with the Apex Global Technologies HR Policy Manual (V4).

Employee Signature:

Printed Name:

Date: _____

Employee ID: _____